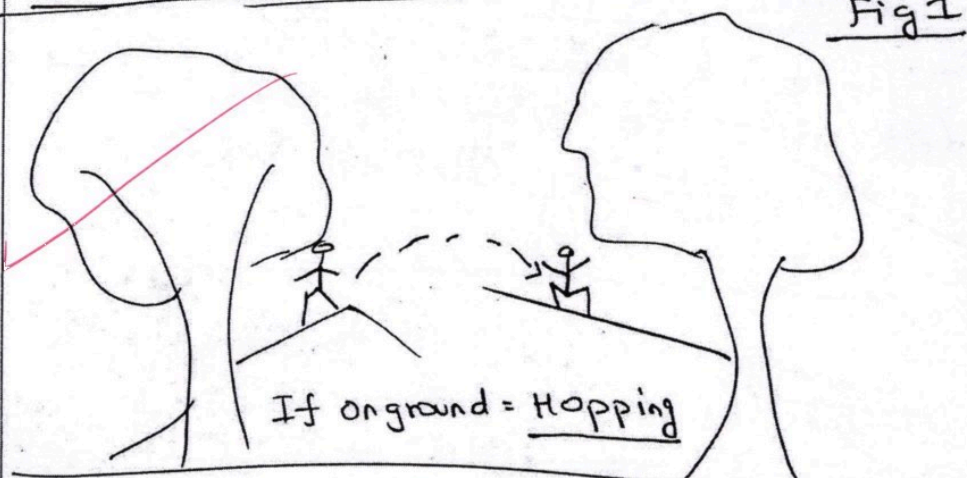


L2A™

(b) Discuss primate locomotion with special reference to adaptations to arboreal life

Locomotion refers to movement from one place to another by the propulsion from the organism itself.
Primates mainly have anatomical adaptations for locomotion for arboreal (tree) & terrestrial habitats.

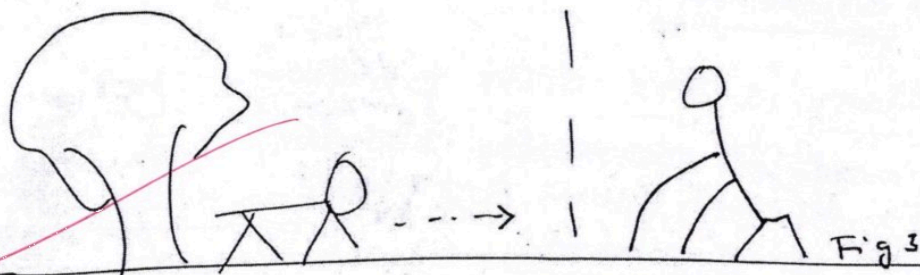
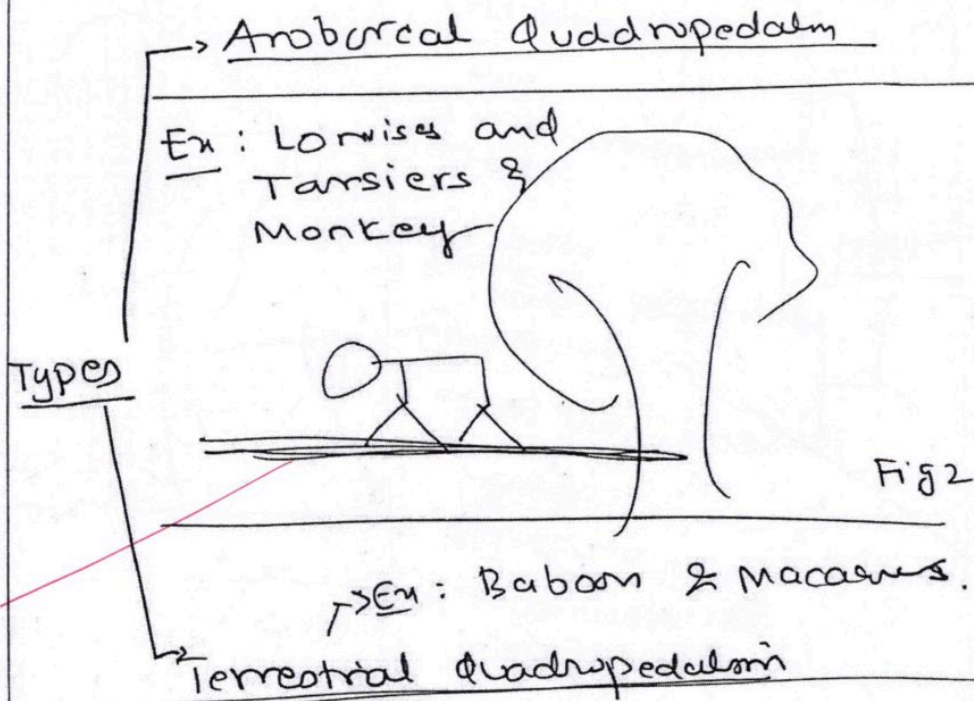
① Vertical Clinging & Leaping



The animal uses its tarsals to propel itself. It is in flight.
Ex: Lemurs & Tarsiers.

② Quadrupedalism

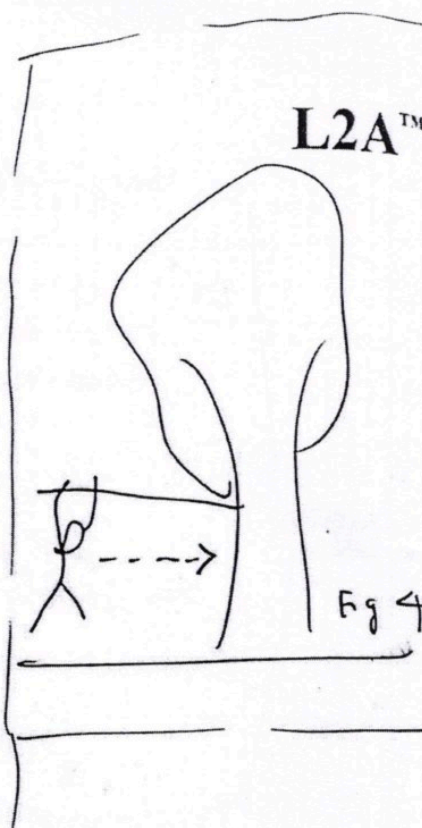
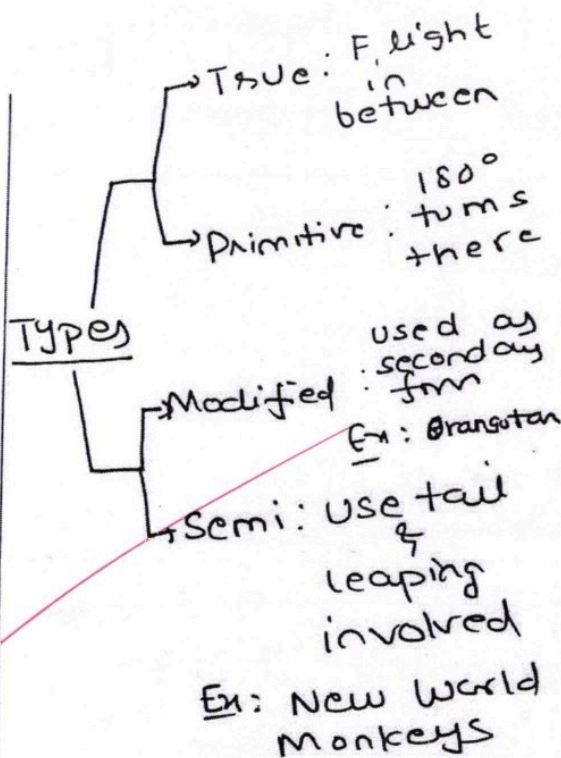
Use of all limbs in propulsion & locomotion.



Its specialised form is said to be Knuckle walking.

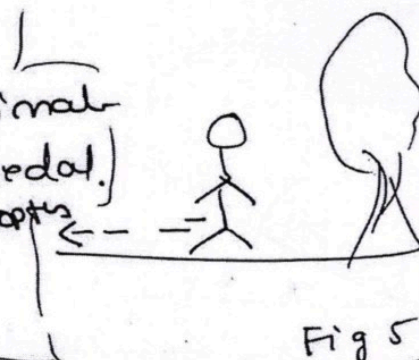
Ex: Apes, Australopithecines etc.
Dryopithecus too (early ones)

(3) Brachiation: It is use of forelimbs
to propel by 180° turn of torso
from branch to branch and also
along branch. Ex: Gibbon & Siamang.



④ Bipedalism

Man is the only primate that is habitually bipedal.
It occurred from Australopithecus about 2.2 m.a



Acc to: Napier & Walker: VC & L → Quadropedal → Bipedal
Not from special form of trachiatry
Walking knuds

Gordon → Bipedalism to free hands led to tools
wasn't Bipedalism most energy efficient

∴ Several adaptations in primates